Causes

- Lens bulging due to aging
- Damage to the optic nerve.
- Reduction in the outflow of aqueous humor

7.9.12 Cancer

Definition

Cancer is a group of diseases characterized by uncontrolled and unregulated growth of cells. Among elderly men concern of the prostrate and colon are the most common while for women it is a breast cancer. Other concern found in geriatric patients are skin, lung and pancreas, bladder, rectum and stomach.

Causes

- Smoking and tobacco
- Diet and physical activity
- Sun and other type of radiation
- Viruses and other infection

Management

- Quit smoking
- Moderate your diet, diets high in fruits and vegetables may have a protective effect against many cancers.
- Avoid excessive exposure to ionizing radiations.
- Regular physical activity and maintain a healthy body weight.



Myths about Aged people

- Aged people are sick
- Aged people cannot learn new things
- Aged people are senile
- Aged people are poor
- Most Aged people live in nursing home
- It is too late for life style changes
- Aged people are unhappy

7.9.13 Drug Reactions

- Older patients are two of three times more vulnerable to drug reaction.
- Drug clearance is markedly reduced due to reaction in Renal blood flow and glomerular filtration rate.
- Distribution of the drug is also affected in old age due to reduction in total body weight content and their relative increases in body fat.
- Protein binding of the drug is decreased due to fall in serum albumin in old age.

CONCLUSION

The ageing process is a profound and life – changing experience. The body slowly begins to weaken, resistance to disease is decreased and recovery time in prolonged. Acute and chronic medical conditions become more common and life – disrupting condition such as incontinence and falls can severely affect independence and quality of life. Many people age 65 or older self – report some sort of disability. These may be minor or they may be significant requiring the older person to need skilled assistance. The ageing process is experienced differently by each of us. But age – related changes are inevitable. Apart from this the types of elderly care services and common disorders of elderly has been included.

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